Billing Scheme elements

Phone prefix

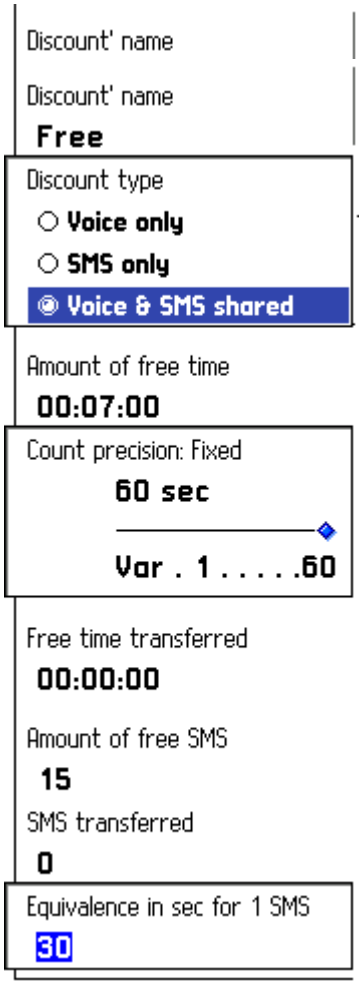
Contains phone numbers prefixes (a few initial digits) or whole numbers for which the corresponding **Price lists** are chosen during calculating.
Adding: *Options->Add shared item->Phone prefix*
It contains also constant, not editable and not removable **All numbers** which identifies any number/prefix

Discounts

Contains free minutes packages and free SMS packages.
Adding: *Options->Add shared item->Discount*
Any packages amount can be defined.
Packages for voice connections require defining the precision to be used by free time decrementing by each use. Values:

- from 1 sec to 60 sec mean CONSTANT precision – every use decrements free time with given precision
- 0 sec means CHANGEABLE precision – every use decrements free time with precision given in the corresponding **Price list** (corresponding to the given call)

Unused discounts from the previous payment periods (free time transferred, SMS transferred) are set automatically after finishing the payment period.
(*Options->Billing scheme->Next payment period*)



Weekend

Contains **Time frame(s)** for which the weekend connections are calculated.

Calendar

Contains public holiday dates, for which the connections are calculated like for weekend days.
Adding: *Options->Add shared item->Holiday date*

Weekdays

Contains **Time frame(s)** for which the weekdays connections are calculated.

Time frame

Occurs only as a part of **Weekend** and **Weekdays**.
It declares time interval from hour – to hour. Contains **Price list(s)** with defined rates and phone numbers prefixes for calls made between declared time boundaries.

Adding: *Options->Add item (joystick left), joystick up/down, joystick center on the chosen position*

Element can be added: 

Element cannot be added: 

Price list

Occuring as a part of **Time frame** contains time interval(s) and prices for them needed to calculate the connection cost.
Occurring as a part of **SMS** contains price for each sent SMS.
Contains link to **Phone prefix** elements, for which the given rates are valid.
Contains link to **Discounts** elements, to consider free values included in the contract.

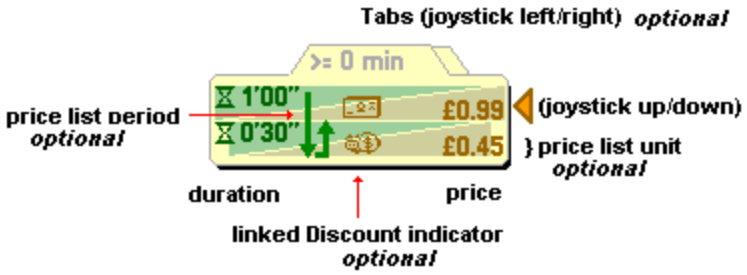
Adding: *Options->Add item (joystick right), joystick up/down, joystick center on the chosen position*

Element can be added: 

Element cannot be added: 

Adding/deleting link to **Phone prefix**: *joystick center on Price list,Link->Phone prefix, joystick up/down, joystick center on the chosen Phone prefix*
Adding/deleting link to **Discount**: *joystick center on Price list,Link->Discount,joystick up/down, joystick center on the chosen Discount*

Price list dialog



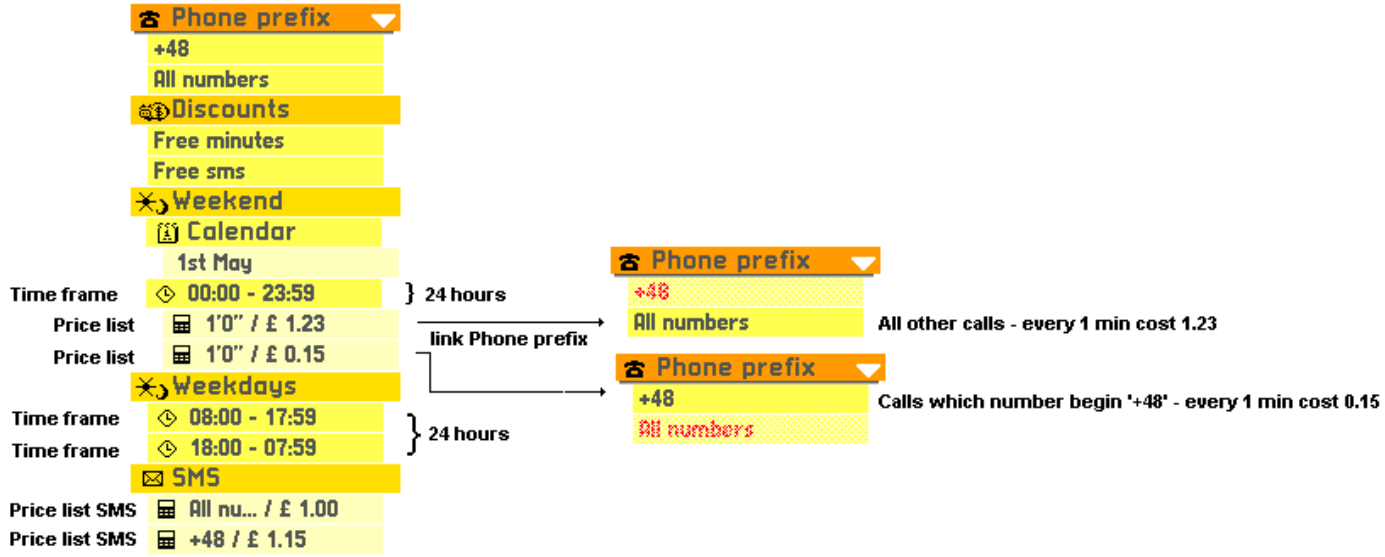
Price list SMS dialog



SMS

Contains **Price list(s)** with defined rates and phone number prefixes for which the costs of sent SMS messages are calculated.*]*

Example Billing Scheme



Billing Scheme defining rules

Simple **Billing Scheme** can be defined using **Wizard** (*Options->Billing scheme->Wizard*).
Such definition allows calculating all calls costs with different prices per 1 minute for week days and for weekends (with or without different rates for peak and off-peak hours). Additionally it is possible to add free minutes to the scheme.

The **Billing Scheme** defined in this way is a good start point for modifications which would allow to adjust the scheme to ones specific needs.
By adding the modifications the following rules are important:

- **Weekend** and **Weekdays** – each of them needs to have one or more **Time frames** depending on costs in different time intervals during the day (peak hours, off-peak, night etc.)
- Summed up time intervals for **Time frame(s)** for **Weekend** ,as well as for **Time frame(s)** for **Weekdays,** should make full 24 hours.
- Every **Time frame** needs to have one or more **Price list(s)**
- Every **Price list** needs to have given time interval and price
- Every **Price list** needs to have a link to at least one **Phone prefix** element, in this way declaring the ability to calculate the cost for calls to the numbers starting with this prefix.
- Every **SMS** needs to have one or more **Price list(s)**, which links to an element from **Phone prefix**. This will enable calculating the cost for messages sent to the numbers beginning with this prefix.

The control over keeping these rules gives the option: *Options->Billing scheme->Find problems*
In case of violating any rule the appropriate message is shown, afterwards the user attention is directed to this Billing Scheme part, which is related to this violation.

The way of calculating phone calls cost

To calculate connections cost select: *Options->Reports->Show bill* It will proceed in the following steps:

1) On the basis of the call date, decision is made whether this day was **Weekend** (if Saturday, Sunday or one of dates saved in **Calendar**) or **Weekday**.
2) Afterwards on the basis of the connection time the **Time frame** is chosen, which contains the start time of the call.
3) In the chosen **Time frame** the **Price list** is searched, with the link to the **Phone prefix** element which has the most accurate beginning for the calculated phone call.
   If no matching link to **Phone prefix** was found among the **Price lists**:
   a) If **Weekend** was searched – further search will proceed in **Weekdays**
   b) If **Weekdays** was searched – calculating is stopped
4) If the chosen **Price list** has **Tabs**, the rates to calculate the cost of the current call will be chosen on the basis of total time of all previous calls.
5) If the chosen **Price list** has the link to the **Discounts** element, the time of the call is shorten according to the selected package before calculating the cost.

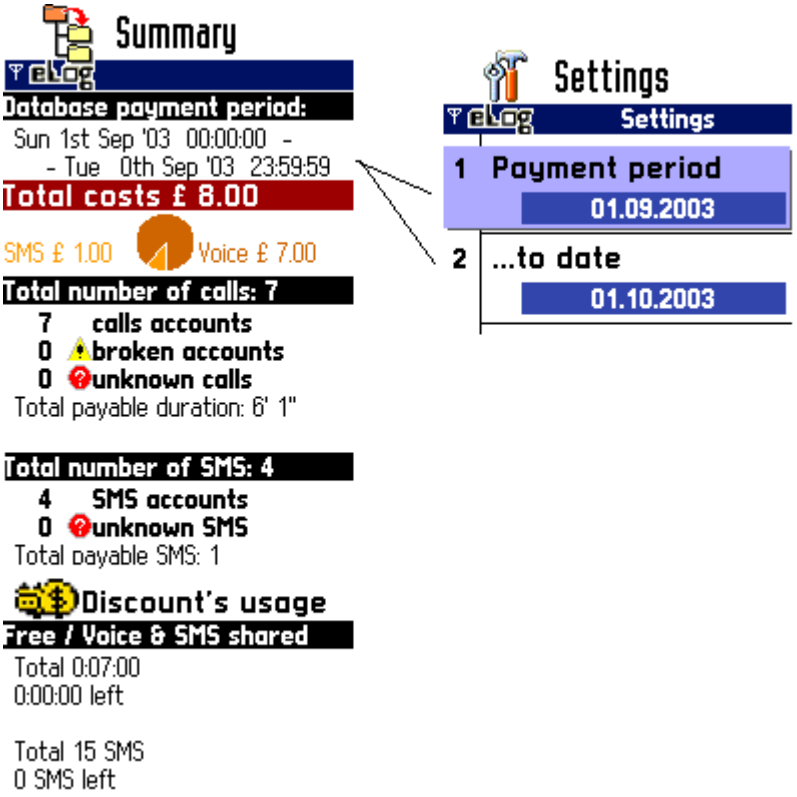
After finishing the summary is shown:

If errors related to phone number matching with **Time frame** + **Price list** sets occurred during calculating it is signalized with the appropriate icon:

(unknown calls) – the cost of this call was not calculated because the phone number couldn't be matched with the prefixes linked to the **Price list(s)** (in other words: no **Price list** has the link to the prefix which matches the calling party phone number)

(broken accounts) – the cost of this calls can be incorrect, because the phone call was made in two **Time frame(s)** – ie. it was begun in peak hours and finished in off-peak – and not in all needed **Price list(s)** there is a link to the prefix matching the calling party phone number)

informs, that this call was not calculated yet.



Price list examples

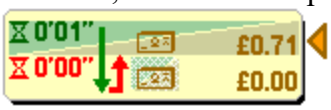
Free connections



Connections, for which the cost is calculated considering attached Discount



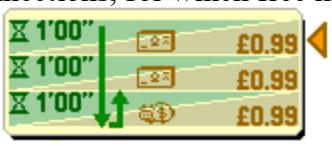
Connections, for which the price is constant – independent of the call duration



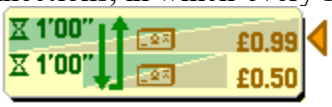
Connections, for which the cost is calculated for each second after the first minute



Connections, for which free minutes package is used only after second minute of the call.



Connections, in which every second minute is cheaper



Connections for which the cost depends on the total time of all previous voice calls:

- If this total time is lower than 15 min – the cost for every 1 minute of the current call is 1
- If this total time is higher than 15 min, but lower than 30 min – the cost for every 1 minute of the current call is 0.85
- If this total time is higher than 30 min – the cost for every 1 minute of the current call is 0.65

